



## **COT4400:**

### **Analysis of Algorithms**

CRN: 15510, Section: 1, Credit Hours: 3

### **COURSE SYLLABUS**

**Semester:** Fall 2024

**Class Meeting Days:** M, W

**Class Meeting Time:** 5:00 pm – 6:15 pm

**Class Meeting Location:** Building: ISA, Room: 1061

**Instructor:** Oguzhan Topsakal, Ph.D.

**Email:** [topsakal@usf.edu](mailto:topsakal@usf.edu)

- Please send all messages via Outlook, not through Canvas.
- Include your course and section information in the subject line.

**Office Location:** BEH-317

**Office Hours:**

- @ My office (BEH-317): Mon & Wed [3:30 pm – 4:30 pm],
- @ MS Teams: Tue [2:30 pm – 4:30 pm]

#### **Teaching Assistants (sorted by office hour day/time):**

- Harshavardan Yuvaraj ([harshavardanyuvaraj@usf.edu](mailto:harshavardanyuvaraj@usf.edu))
  - Hours-Location: Mondays 9am-11am [Location: ENB-327]
- Advait Subramanian Sahasranamam ([advait@usf.edu](mailto:advait@usf.edu))
  - Hours-Location: Tuesdays 13pm-15pm [Location: ENB-325]
- Khanh Quoc Duong ([duong3@usf.edu](mailto:duong3@usf.edu))
  - Hours-Location: Wednesdays 14pm-16pm [Location: ENB-323]
- Md Hasin Khan ([mdhasink@usf.edu](mailto:mdhasink@usf.edu))
  - Hours-Location: Thursdays 10am-12pm [Location: ENB-325]
- Tran Ho ([tbho@usf.edu](mailto:tbho@usf.edu))
  - Hours-Location: Thursday 12pm-14pm [Location: ENB-323]
- Anthony Martini ([acmartini@usf.edu](mailto:acmartini@usf.edu))
  - Hours-Location: Fridays 15pm-17pm [Location: ENB-323]

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#### **I. Welcome!**

Hello, my name is Professor Oguzhan Topsakal. Welcome to the Analysis of Algorithms course! I have taught Algorithms courses many times and enjoyed it very much. This is one of the core and fundamental courses of computer science. Please spend adequate time on this course so that you learn and get the most out of this course. Please do not hesitate to contact me ([topsakal@usf.edu](mailto:topsakal@usf.edu)) to discuss or ask anything about this course.

## II. University Course Description

Design principles and analysis techniques applicable to various classes of computer algorithms frequently used in practice.

## III. Course Prerequisites

COT 3100 (Introduction to Discrete Structures), COP 4530 (Data Structures).

## IV. Course Purpose

This course on Algorithm Design provides a comprehensive exploration of fundamental and advanced concepts in algorithm development and analysis. It equips students with the skills necessary to prove the correctness of algorithms, analyze their complexity using Big-Oh notation, and assess the trade-offs associated with different data structures under varying conditions. The course also covers a range of algorithm design strategies, such as greedy algorithms, divide-and-conquer, dynamic programming, and backtracking. Students will learn to apply these strategies to solve complex problems efficiently. The curriculum includes a focus on traditional search and graph algorithms, enabling students to understand their advantages and disadvantages and apply them effectively to various problem types. Furthermore, students will learn to classify problems into computational complexity classes such as P, NP, NP-Hard, and NP-Complete, and will develop the ability to establish upper or lower complexity bounds for specific problems based on problem reductions.

This course is a **core component** of the computer science curriculum, playing a crucial role in the development of a strong foundation in theoretical computer science and practical problem-solving skills. Algorithm design is a **fundamental skill** for computer scientists and software engineers, as it underpins the creation of efficient software systems and applications. Mastery of algorithms is essential for tackling real-world challenges, optimizing performance, and ensuring that solutions are scalable and robust.

This course is essential for students pursuing careers in software development, data analysis, artificial intelligence, and research. Understanding algorithm design and analysis is also critical for those preparing for technical interviews in the tech industry, where such knowledge is often a key component of the hiring process.

This course not only strengthens students' problem-solving abilities but also enhances their critical thinking skills by challenging them to analyze and optimize algorithms across a variety of contexts. As technology continues to advance and the demand for efficient, high-performance systems grows, the relevance of this course remains paramount.

## V. Course Format

The course format emphasizes a balanced integration of interactive lectures, discussions, and hands-on activities. This approach involves active learning strategies, where class time is dedicated to significant discussions and collaborative learning alongside traditional lectures. We also plan to incorporate AI tools to further enhance the learning experience. This strategy will allow students to engage deeply with the material, apply concepts in real-time, and learn from the instructor, peers, and advanced software tools.

Class time will blend all three elements: lectures, discussions, and out of class learning. Lectures will introduce and explain key concepts, while discussions will enable students to delve deeper into the

material, ask questions, and clarify their understanding. Out-of-class learning will be facilitated through assignments and projects, allowing students to solve problems and apply theoretical concepts in practical scenarios.

The course will be delivered in a face-to-face format, with in-person sessions focused on interactive lectures and group discussions. However, the course will also include online components. The online platform will be used for continued discussions, submission of assignments, and projects through tools such as discussion boards and software that enhances algorithm visualization, application, and understanding. Online discussions further support learning by offering a platform for continuous engagement, where students can reflect on lectures, share insights, and seek support from peers and instructors. By integrating software tools, we provide a hands-on experience that allows students to visualize and test algorithms, effectively bridging the gap between theory and practice.

## **VI. Student Learning Outcomes**

On successful completion of the course, students should be able to:

- prove the correctness or incorrectness of a given algorithm
- analyze the complexity of algorithms using Big-Oh notation, including graph algorithms
- analyze the trade-offs involved in using different data structures and assess their pros and cons under various conditions
- develop efficient solutions to problems using various algorithm design strategies, including greedy algorithms, divide-and-conquer, dynamic programming, and backtracking
- apply several traditional search and graph algorithms to problems
- describe the advantages and disadvantages of these search and graph algorithms
- classify problems into the classes P, NP, NP-Hard, and NP-Complete
- establish upper or lower complexity bounds on a problem based on a given problem reduction

## **VII. Course Objectives**

The goals of COT 4400 are to:

- develop students' abilities to analyze the correctness and complexity of algorithms, including graph algorithms
- familiarize students with the fundamentals of developing efficient algorithms, including classical algorithm design strategies and data structures
- introduce students to the theory of NP-Completeness

## **VIII. Required Texts and/or Readings and Course Materials**

- The Algorithm Design Manual, Steven Skiena, 3rd ed. (ISBN-13: 978-3030542559)

## **IX. Supplementary (Optional) Texts and Materials**

- Introduction to Algorithms, Cormen, Leiserson, Rivest, and Stein (CLRS), 3rd ed. (ISBN-13: 978-0262033848)

## **X. How to Succeed in this Course**

- Attend every class.
- Stay engaged during class.
- Ask questions and actively participate by answering the instructor's questions.
- Review lecture notes and slides after class.
- Read the textbook thoroughly.
- Complete assignments on time.

- Supplement your learning with online tutorials, videos, and forums specific to algorithms.
- Challenge yourself with problems outside the class to deepen your understanding.
- Practice and implement algorithms in code to solidify your understanding.
- Discuss concepts and solve problems with peers.
- Don't hesitate to seek help from the instructor and TAs.

#### XI. Academic Continuity

During any semester, there is a possibility the course may be disrupted, whether due to continued pandemic or hurricane season. If we are not able to continue meeting in person, the course will continue remotely. In this case, classes will be held synchronously on Microsoft Teams, and exams will be proctored using HonorLock. Further resources for taking an online exam using HonorLock will be posted if this becomes necessary.

#### XII. Communication

Outside of class communications will be done through canvas, MS Teams or via email. Announcements can be found on Canvas.

The instructor **prefers to receive emails directly** (not through Canvas) to help keep track of communication. When emailing the instructor (or the TAs), please **ensure that the course number and name are included in the subject line**.

#### XIII. Feedback

There will be feedback surveys assigned during the course. Completing these surveys will award bonus points towards your homework score.

Additional feedback (positive or negative) is highly encouraged throughout the course. Feedback may be sent to the instructor ([topsakal@usf.edu](mailto:topsakal@usf.edu)) by email or Canvas.

#### XIV. Grading Scale

Letter grades will be assigned according to the following scale:

##### Grading Scale (%)

|           |    |
|-----------|----|
| 93 – 100  | A  |
| 90 – 92.9 | A- |
| 87 – 89.9 | B+ |
| 83 – 86.9 | B  |
| 80 – 82.9 | B- |
| 77 – 79.9 | C+ |
| 73 – 76.9 | C  |
| 70 – 72.9 | C- |
| 60 – 69.9 | D  |
| 0 – 59.9  | F  |

#### XV. Grade Categories and Weights

Provide a listing of assessments and their weighting in the semester total. In addition to (or even in lieu of) tests, consider exploring “authentic” assessments, which are based as closely as possible to real world experiences. Here is an example:

**Graded Items**  
Exams

**Percent of Final Grade**  
60%

|                                                 |     |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----|
| Homework                                        | 20% |
| Project(s)                                      | 10% |
| Participation (Attendance, Quizzes, Discussion) | 10% |

**Threshold grading policy:** Students who receive an average of less than 60 on the exams will not receive an overall passing grade in the course.

### **Project Assignments**

There will be projects throughout the course. Note that you might need to prepare a demonstration of your final project and a report during the Test Free Week. Several homework assignments will also be given.

### **Homework Policy**

Homework will be assigned during the course and will be **due 10:59 pm** and will be accepted online until 11:59 pm the day it is due. Assignments will **not be accepted after this time**. The instructor reserves the right to assess homework assignments on a submitted basis, where submissions will be graded based on the number of questions attempted. The grading policy will not be announced before the assignment is due. Failure to properly cite external sources such as websites for homework assignments is a violation of academic integrity and will be dealt with accordingly.

### **Exams**

There will be three exams including the final exam:

- The first exam should cover algorithm correctness, complexity and data structures.
- The second exam should cover divide & conquer, graph algorithms and greedy algorithms.
- The final exam will be cumulative but will focus on complexity theory, dynamic programming, backtracking.

Exam dates will be announced in class and on canvas.

Note that the instructor reserves the right to adjust exam topics to align with the material covered in class. The instructor also reserves the right to give additional assessments on an as-needed basis.

### **Participation and Engagement**

Participation grades will partially be based on in-class attendance quizzes. If you participate 80% of the participation quizzes, you will receive full credit for attendance.

## **XVI. Instructor Feedback Policy & Grade Dissemination**

We aim to grade and provide feedback on your assignments (and exams) within 10 days of the due date. If you do not see your grades in two weeks after the due date, feel free to contact the instructor.

You will receive grades and feedback on your assignments via Canvas. Click on Grades in the menu at the left to access the Canvas grade book and click on a graded assignment to see feedback about how your assignment was graded. Note that the summary columns automatically generated by Canvas may not accurately reflect your grade as determined by the grade weighting above.

Note that if you believe that an error has been made in grading, a request must be submitted to the TA no later than one week after the assignment or exam is returned.

Once the grades for assignments and exams are made available, you have two weeks to review, discuss, and request a regrade if needed. **After two weeks from the date the grades are posted, reconsideration of the grades will no longer be possible.**

## XVII. Course Schedule.

Please also see the final exam schedule here: [university scheduled final exam time](#).

| Week | Topic(s)                                                | Assignments [Each class might have in class participation activity/quiz] |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Algorithm correctness                                   |                                                                          |
| 2    | Big-Oh notation                                         | Homework 1 assigned                                                      |
| 3    | Algorithm analysis                                      | Homework 1 due,                                                          |
| 4    | Recursive algorithm analysis                            | Homework 2 assigned                                                      |
| 5    | Sorting and data structures review                      | Homework 2 due                                                           |
| 6    | Review and <b>Exam 1 – Feb 23<sup>rd</sup> 11:30 AM</b> | Homework 3 assigned,                                                     |
| 7    | Divide-and-conquer algorithms                           | Project assigned                                                         |
| 8    | Graph traversals & algorithms                           | Project Part 1 assigned                                                  |
| 9    | Greedy algorithms                                       | Project Part 1 due                                                       |
| 10   | Review and <b>Exam 2 – Mar 31<sup>st</sup> 17:00 PM</b> | Homework 4 assigned Project Part 2 due                                   |
| 11   | Dynamic programming                                     | Homework 4 due                                                           |
| 12   | Backtracking                                            | Homework 5 assigned                                                      |
| 13   | Complexity theory                                       | Homework 5 due, Project Part 3 due                                       |
| 14   | Coping with non-polynomial algorithms                   | Project report and demo                                                  |
| 15   | Final exam review                                       |                                                                          |

\* Note: The schedule is **subject to revision**

## XVIII. USF Core Syllabus Policies

USF has a set of central policies related to student recording class sessions, academic integrity and grievances, student accessibility services, academic disruption, religious observances, academic continuity, food insecurity, and sexual harassment that **apply to all courses at USF**. Be sure to review these online: [usf.edu/provost/faculty-success/resources-policies-forms/core-syllabus-policy-statements.aspx](https://usf.edu/provost/faculty-success/resources-policies-forms/core-syllabus-policy-statements.aspx)

## XIX. Student Recordings

Please check the university policy here: [usf.edu/provost/faculty-success/resources-policies-forms/core-syllabus-policy-statements.aspx](https://usf.edu/provost/faculty-success/resources-policies-forms/core-syllabus-policy-statements.aspx)

Additional guidance related to the [Intellectual Freedom and Viewpoint Diversity Act](#).

## XX. Course Policies: Grades

### Late Work Policy:

There are no make-ups for in-class work. No late work will be accepted after the due date. Exceptions might be given for late homework to whom have presented a valid excuse **before the due date**.

### Medical Excuses:

Students should not attend class if they are ill, particularly if they have fever and/or gastrointestinal symptoms and/or respiratory symptoms such as a sneezing, runny nose, sore throat or coughing. Students experiencing any of these symptoms should contact immediately the Student Health Services (813-974-2331) on the Sarasota-Mantatee and Tampa campus or the Wellness Center (727-873-4422) on the St. Petersburg campus for appropriate medical

guidance and to obtain a verification of care letter. Students may turn to other health providers as well. **To be approved for missed classes, late assignments or missed examinations a verification of care letter must be presented by the student to the faculty member upon return to class.**

**Extra Credit Policy:**

There might be extra credit assignments which will be announced in class and on Canvas. If extra credit is granted, additional points will be added to the homework section or to your overall points of the course.

**Grades of "Incomplete":** Offer specifics about your policy on incomplete grades.

The current university policy concerning incomplete grades will be followed in this course.

**Attendance Policy:**

Students are expected to attend classes. There will be in-class activities to check the attendance.

**Campus Free Expression:**

It is fundamental to the University of South Florida's mission to support an environment where divergent ideas, theories, and philosophies can be openly exchanged and critically evaluated. Consistent with these principles, this course may involve discussion of ideas that you find uncomfortable, disagreeable, or even offensive.

In the instructional setting, ideas are intended to be presented in an objective manner and not as an endorsement of what you should personally believe. "Objective" means that the idea(s) presented can be tested by critical peer review and rigorous debate, and that the idea(s) is supported by credible research.

**Make-up Exams Policy:**

If a student cannot be present for an examination for a valid reason (validity to be determined by the instructor), a make-up exam will be given only if the student has notified the instructor in advance that s/he cannot be present for the exam. Make-up exams are given at the convenience of the instructor.

**Exam Retention Policy:**

After exams are graded, the instructor will review the examination with the class and collect all exams. The exams will be retained for one semester following the current one, and then they will be destroyed.

**Group Work Policy:**

This course does not include any assignments requiring group work; all assignments are to be completed individually. If a group assignment is introduced, the specific group work policy will be explained at that time. Since all assignments are individual, submitting an assignment prepared collaboratively as a group will be treated as a **violation of academic integrity**.

**Final Examinations Policy:** All final exams are to be scheduled in accordance with the University's final examination policy.

**XXI. Course Policies: Technology and Media**

**Canvas:**

This course will be offered via USF's learning management system (LMS), Canvas. If you need help learning how to perform various tasks related to this course or other courses being offered in Canvas, please view the following videos or consult the Canvas help guides. You may also contact USF's IT department at (813) 974-1222 or [help@usf.edu](mailto:help@usf.edu).

Students are expected to check canvas page daily for course materials, assignments and announcements.

**Recordings:**

*We **might** record lectures if needed. Therefore, please read:*

In this class, software will be used to record live class lectures and discussions. As a student in this class, your participation in live class discussions will be recorded. These recordings will be made available only to students enrolled in the class, to assist those who cannot attend the live session or to serve as a resource for those who would like to review content that was presented. Students who prefer to participate via audio only will be allowed to disable their video camera so only audio will be captured. Please discuss this option with your instructor.

**Online Exam Proctoring:**

*We **might** utilize online exam proctoring tools if needed. Therefore, please read:*

All students must review the syllabus and the requirements, including the online terms and video testing requirements, to determine if they wish to remain in the course. Enrollment in the course is an agreement to abide by and accept all terms. Any student may elect to drop or withdraw from this course before the end of the drop/add period.

Online exams and quizzes within this course may require online proctoring. Therefore, students will be required to have a webcam (USB or internal) with a microphone when taking an exam or quiz. Students understand that this remote recording device is purchased and controlled by the student and that recordings from any private residence must be done with the permission of any person residing in the residence.

To avoid any concerns in this regard, students should select private spaces for the testing. Students with concerns may discuss location of an appropriate space for the recordings with their instructor or advisor.

Students must ensure that any recordings do not invade any third-party privacy rights and accept all responsibility and liability for violations of any third-party privacy concerns. Students are strictly responsible for ensuring that they take all exams using a reliable computer and high-speed internet connection. Setup information will be provided prior to taking the proctored exam. To use Honorlock, students are required to download and install the [Honorlock Google Chrome extension](#). For additional information please visit the [USF online proctoring student FAQ](#) and [Honorlock student resources](#).

**Laptop Usage:**

Laptop usage in class is **not permitted** unless otherwise instructed. There will be specific activities that require the use of laptops, and I will inform you in advance to bring them for those sessions. However, I **discourage the use of laptops when it becomes a distraction or is used for purposes unrelated to the course**. If you use your laptop for anything other than learning the course material, you may be asked to leave the class for the remainder of the day.

**WhatsApp, GroupMe, Discord and Student-to-Student Communication:**



While students may use digital communication tools (WhatsApp, GroupMe, Discord etc.) to communicate with fellow students, it is important to remember that academic integrity policies still apply in these environments. Informing others about the contents of tests is prohibited by [the official regulation](#), as is receiving unauthorized information about an examination. Students are expected and required to immediately report instances of such violations to the instructor.

**Phone Usage:**

Phone usage is not allowed in the class **including texting or surfing the Internet**.

**Earbuds/Headphones Usage:**

The use of earbuds/headphones during class is specifically **not allowed** and students who engage in this behavior **may be asked to leave** the class for the day (noting exceptions for authorized accommodations).

**XXII. Course Policies: Student Expectations**

**Health and Wellness:**

Your health is a priority at the University of South Florida. We encourage members of our community to look out for each another and to reach out for help if someone is in need. If you or someone you know is in distress, please make a referral at [www.usf.edu/sos](http://www.usf.edu/sos) so that the Student Outreach & Support can contact and provide helpful resources to the student in distress. A 24-hour licensed mental healthcare professional, offered through the counseling center, is available by phone at 813-974-2831, option 3. Please remember that asking for help is a sign of strength. In case of emergency, please dial 9-1-1.

**Title IX Policy:**

Title IX provides federal protections for discrimination based on sex, which includes discrimination based on pregnancy, sexual harassment, and interpersonal violence. In an effort to provide support and equal access, **USF has designated all faculty (TA, Adjunct, etc.) as Responsible Employees, who are required to report any disclosures of sexual harassment, sexual violence, relationship violence or stalking.** The Title IX Office makes every effort, when safe to do so, to reach out and provide resources and accommodations, and to discuss possible options for resolution. Anyone wishing to make a Title IX report or seeking accommodations may do so online, in person, via phone, or email to the Title IX Office. For information about Title IX or for a full list of resources please visit: <https://www.usf.edu/title-ix/gethelp/resources.aspx>. *If you are unsure what to do, please contact Victim Advocacy – a confidential resource that can review all your options – at 813-974-5756 or [va@admin.usf.edu](mailto:va@admin.usf.edu).*

**Usage of Generative AI Tools:**

**Purpose:** The purpose of this policy is to foster a dynamic learning environment that encourages technological adaptation, innovative thinking, and the ethical use of AI resources in academic endeavors.

**Policy:**

1. **Definition of Generative AI Tools:** Generative AI tools refer to any artificial intelligence-powered software, program or application that can generate content, including but not limited to text, visuals, music, and other creative outputs. Examples of these tools include AI code generators, AI text generators, AI content rewriters, AI graphic generators, etc.
2. **Permitted Use:** The use of generative AI tools is **NOT** permitted for course-related submissions, including assignments, projects, presentations, examinations, and other forms

- of assessment unless otherwise directed. If allowed for any coursework, students must responsibly use these tools, adhering to the guidelines outlined in this policy.
3. Student Responsibility: If allowed explicitly for a coursework, Students are responsible for appropriately using generative AI tools in their work. This includes:
    - a. Citing all AI-generated content used in their submissions. Students must explicitly detail how AI-generated content was used in their submission.
    - b. Demonstrating a deep understanding of the subject matter, not solely relying on AI-generated content. Cross-reference claims and statements with original sources and providing appropriate citations are expected.
    - c. Using AI tools as a supplemental resource (i.e., as an editor), not as the primary means of completing assignments.
    - d. Understanding that generative AI tools, while powerful, are not infallible and can produce misinformation or inaccurate results. Students are responsible for the accuracy of their submissions and must cross-verify the information produced by these tools with reliable sources.
  4. Violation Consequences: Misuse of AI tools, including use of AI that undermines the student learning objectives of the course or assignment, failing to cite AI-generated content, relying too heavily on AI for work completion, or submitting inaccurate information generated by AI tools, will be subject to academic penalties. Consequences may range from a reduction in an individual assignment grade to larger academic sanctions per USF policy, depending on the severity of the violation (USF Regulation 3.027).
  5. Exceptions: If there are specific assignments where the use of AI tools is appropriate, these will be clearly marked in the assignment guidelines. Students must adhere to these specific instructions.
  6. Questions and Clarifications: If students are unsure whether a tool they wish to use qualifies as a generative AI tool, or if they have questions regarding the allowable use of such tools, they should consult with the course instructor before using it.

#### **Course Hero / Chegg Policy:**

The [USF Policy on Academic Integrity](#) specifies that students may not use websites that enable cheating, such as by uploading or downloading material for this purpose. This does apply specifically to Chegg.com and CourseHero.com – almost any use of these websites (including uploading proprietary materials) constitutes a violation of the academic integrity policy.

#### **Professionalism Policy:**

Per university policy and classroom etiquette; mobile phones, iPods, etc. **must be silenced** during all classroom and lab lectures. Those not heeding this rule will be asked to leave the classroom/lab immediately so as to not disrupt the learning environment. Please arrive on time for all class meetings. Students who habitually disturb the class by talking, arriving late, etc., and have been warned may suffer a reduction in their final class grade.

#### **Turnitin.com:**

*In this course, turnitin.com will be utilized. Turnitin is an automated system which instructors may use to quickly and easily compare each student's assignment with billions of web sites, as well as an enormous database of student papers that grows with each submission. After the assignment is processed, as instructor I receive a report from turnitin.com that states if and how another author's work was used in the assignment. For a more detailed look at this process visit <http://www.turnitin.com>. Essays are due at turnitin.com the same day as in class.*

### **Netiquette Guidelines**

1. Act professionally in the way you communicate. Treat your instructors and peers with respect, the same way you would do in a face-to-face environment. Respect other people's ideas and be constructive when explaining your views about points you may not agree with.
2. Be sensitive. Be respectful and sensitive when sharing your ideas and opinions. There will be people in your class with different linguistic backgrounds, political and religious beliefs or other general differences.
3. Proofread and check spelling. Doing this before sending an email or posting a thread on a discussion board will allow you to make sure your message is clear and thoughtful. Avoid the use of all capital letters, it can be perceived as if you are shouting, and it is more difficult to read.
4. Keep your communications focused and stay on topic. Complete your ideas before changing the subject. By keeping the message on focus you allow the readers to easily get your idea or answers they are looking for.
5. Be clear with your message. Avoid using humor or sarcasm. Since people can't see your expressions or hear your tone of voice, meaning can be misinterpreted.

### **End of Semester Student Evaluations:**

All classes at USF make use of an online system for students to provide feedback to the University regarding the course. These surveys will be made available at the end of the semester, and the University will notify you by email when the response window opens. Your participation is highly encouraged and valued.

### **Food and Drink Policy:**

Please adhere to the firm policy of **NO beverages (other than bottled/capped water), food, tobacco products, or like items in the classroom**. Your understanding of the necessity for this policy and cooperation will be greatly appreciated. This policy will be strictly enforced.

## **XXIII. Learning Support and Campus Offices**

### **Academic Accommodations**

Students with disabilities are responsible for registering with Student Accessibility Services (SAS) in order to receive academic accommodations. SAS encourages students to notify instructors of accommodation needs at least 5 business days prior to needing the accommodation. Notification from SAS must accompany this request.

For additional information about academic accommodations and resources, you can visit the SAS website.

[SAS website for the Tampa and Sarasota-Manatee campuses.](#)

[SAS website for the St. Pete campus.](#)

### **Academic Support Services**

The USF Office of Student Success coordinates and promotes university-wide efforts to enhance undergraduate and graduate student success. For a comprehensive list of academic support services available to all USF students, please visit the [Office of Student Success website.](#)

### **Canvas Technical Support**

*If you have technical difficulties in Canvas, you can find access to the Canvas guides and video resources in the "Canvas Help" page on the homepage of your Canvas course. You can also contact the help desk by calling 813-974-1222 in Tampa or emailing [help@usf.edu](mailto:help@usf.edu).*

[IT website for the Tampa campus.](#)

[IT website for the St. Pete campus.](#)

[IT website for the Sarasota-Manatee campus.](#)

### **Center for Victim Advocacy**

The [Center for Victim Advocacy](#) empowers survivors of crime, violence, or abuse by promoting the restoration of decision making, by advocating for their rights, and by offering support and resources. Contact information is available online.

### **Counseling Center**

The Counseling Center promotes the wellbeing of the campus community by providing culturally sensitive counseling, consultation, prevention, and training that enhances student academic and personal success. Contact information is available online.

[Counseling Center website for the Tampa campus.](#)

[Counseling Center website for the St. Pete campus.](#)

[Counseling Center website for the Sarasota-Manatee campus.](#)

### **Counseling Center for COE Students**

The USF Counseling Center offers clinical services that are free, confidential, and available to all currently registered USF undergraduate and graduate students.

For College of Engineering students, this Fall 2024 semester, we are also offering individual counseling onsite BY APPOINTMENT ONLY on Wednesdays and Thursdays from 2-5pm at COE (Engineering Building II, Room ENB 201 (2nd Floor)).

View our website to complete new client forms, then call to make an appointment.

<https://ti-wc.mscloud.usf.edu/TitaniumWeb/>

Students can make an appointment at COE with embedded clinician, Michelle Morton LMHC, by calling the Counseling Center at 813-974-2831 during business hours (8am-5pm).

### **Tutoring**

The Tutoring Hub offers free tutoring in several subjects to USF undergraduates. Appointments are recommended, but not required. For more information, email [asctampa@usf.edu](mailto:asctampa@usf.edu).

[Tutoring website for the Tampa campus.](#)

[Tutoring website for the St. Pete campus.](#)

[Tutoring website for the Sarasota-Manatee campus.](#)

### **Writing Studio**

The Writing Studio is a free resource for USF undergraduate and graduate students. At the Writing Studio, a trained writing consultant will work individually with you, at any point in the writing process from brainstorming to editing. Appointments are recommended, but not required. For more information or to make an appointment, email: [writingstudio@usf.edu](mailto:writingstudio@usf.edu).

[Writing studio website for the Tampa campus.](#)

[Writing studio website for the St. Pete campus.](#)

[Writing studio website for the Sarasota-Manatee campus.](#)

## **XXIV. Important Dates to Remember**

Please note that all the dates and assignments are tentative and can be changed at the discretion of the professor.

For important USF dates, see the [Academic Calendar](http://www.usf.edu/registrar/calendars/) at <http://www.usf.edu/registrar/calendars/>

|                                             |                            |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <i>Drop/Add Deadline:</i>                   | <i>Fri, 01/17/25</i>       |
| <i>Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. Holiday:</i> | <i>Mon, 01/20/25</i>       |
| <i>Mid-term Grading Opens:</i>              | <i>Mon, 02/17/25</i>       |
| <i>Mid-term Grading Closes:</i>             | <i>Tues, 03/04/25</i>      |
| <i>Spring Break</i>                         | <i>03/17/25 – 03/23/25</i> |
| <i>Withdrawal Deadline:</i>                 | <i>Sat, 03/29/25</i>       |
| <i>Final Examination Week:</i>              | <i>05/03/25 – 05/08/25</i> |